

Sharp Shooters

Digit *dhamaka* in the midst of crackers and sparklers

For three months in a row, the editorial team has had its hands full with researching, compiling and then cross checking the details for the October 'Smart Buyers' issue, the November 'Web Awards' issue and the December 'Zero1 Awards' issue.

But there was a slight twist in the tale while working on the December issue. With the Digit redesign planned for the January 2002 issue, we had our hands full and more, what with working on the current issue, and simultaneously brainstorming, experimenting with design and planning for the January redesign.

the design team insisting that every square inch of the printed page pass the scrutiny of their eagle eyes and the design team was working away on visuals and getting the aesthetics of the layouts right.

At the same time, there were meetings galore with thoughts, ideas, files and folders being bandied about. In the midst of the endless cups of coffee and the focus on getting the December issue done with, we forgot that the festival of lights was upon us. We missed Diwali...but only nearly so.

The first inkling we received of there being something up in the air was when we heard a distinct gunshot somewhere in the distance. The sounds came closer and we saw Maulik, our CEO, walking around armed with a 'Beretta' taking pot shots at the ceiling.

The crack of firearms had some of us thinking that work rules had changed drastically. But our 'fears' were laid to rest—this was just Maulik's way of reminding us that the festival was way past the 'round the corner' stage.

There were strict instructions to buck up with the day's work as later in the evening we were to be treated to a display of fireworks. Those who looked reluctant to tear themselves away from their work, found a gun staring them in the face, with Maulik threatening to turn trigger-happy. That was enough to get the party poopers to their feet and scramble to the terrace of our office building to watch the 'son et lumiere' unfold.

Enthusiasm is never lacking at Digit and soon we had technical writers, programming geeks, marketing maestros and events specialists getting their hands dirty with the heavy artillery—out came the rockets and 'rassi bombs'. As the rockets lit up the sky, the 'oohs' and 'aahs' from the crowd were interspersed with 'DUCK' as a few of the fire crackers found their way into the unwary but gleeful public. ■



Illustration: Mahesh Benkar

But despite the extra work, things were pretty much normal till we reached the final lap of closing issue. The writers (Anil, Vidyaramanan, Prashant, Sriram and Avina) were frantically verifying and checking and checking once again on the figures, statistics and the finer nuances of their stories, the copy editors (Roopa, Julian and Anshul) were shuttling between the writers and